

STEWARDSHIP

Theme Scripture

Matthew 25:14–30

Key Verse

“Moreover it is required in stewards, that a man be found faithful.”
— *1 Corinthians 4:2*

Introduction

Stewardship is the biblical responsibility of managing everything God has entrusted to us. Since God is the Creator and Owner of all things, believers are called to faithfully oversee their time, talents, finances, opportunities, relationships, and resources for His glory. Stewardship is not about ownership but about accountability. Every Christian is a steward who will one day give an account to God for how they used what was placed in their care.

The Parable of the Talents teaches that God entrusts different resources to different people according to their abilities and expects faithful management. Stewardship is therefore an act of worship, obedience, and service to God.

Supporting Scriptures

- **Matthew 25:14–30** – The Parable of the Talents.
- **Psalms 24:1** – "The earth is the Lord's, and everything in it."
- **1 Corinthians 4:2** – "It is required in stewards that a man be found faithful."
- **Romans 14:12** – "Each of us shall give account of himself to God."

Key Lesson

Everything belongs to God, and believers are called to manage His resources faithfully.

Chapter 1: Understanding Biblical Stewardship

Stewardship is a foundational biblical principle that teaches believers how to relate to God, possessions, responsibilities, opportunities, and blessings. Before a person can become a faithful steward, they must first understand that God is the rightful owner of everything. Nothing we possess truly belongs to us; everything has been entrusted to us by God for a season and for a purpose.

From the beginning of creation, God established humanity as stewards over His creation. He gave mankind authority to manage the earth, but not ownership of it. As believers, we are called to manage God's resources in ways that honor Him and advance His kingdom.

Biblical stewardship goes beyond money. It includes our time, talents, spiritual gifts, relationships, opportunities, influence, possessions, and ministry responsibilities. One day every believer will stand before God and give an account of how they managed what He entrusted to them.

The central question of stewardship is not, "What belongs to me?" but rather, "How does God want me to use what belongs to Him?"

1. The Meaning of Stewardship

A steward is a person entrusted with the responsibility of managing the property, affairs, or resources of another person.

In biblical times, wealthy landowners often appointed trusted servants to oversee their households, finances, workers, and property. Although the steward had authority to manage these resources, he did not own them. His responsibility was to use them according to the owner's instructions.

Likewise, believers are God's stewards. We manage what belongs to Him.

1 Corinthians 4:2

"Moreover it is required in stewards, that a man be found faithful."

Notice that God does not primarily require success, wealth, fame, or influence. He requires faithfulness. The measure of a steward is not how much he has but how faithfully he manages what he has been given.

Key Truth

Stewardship is the faithful management of God's resources according to God's purposes.

2. God Is the Owner of Everything

The foundation of stewardship begins with recognizing God's ownership.

Psalms 24:1

"The earth is the Lord's, and the fullness thereof; the world, and they that dwell therein."

This verse teaches that:

- God owns the earth.
- God owns every resource.
- God owns every person.
- God owns every blessing.
- God owns our lives.

Many people view themselves as owners of their possessions, careers, talents, and accomplishments. However, Scripture reminds us that everything ultimately belongs to God.

Haggai 2:8

"The silver is mine, and the gold is mine, saith the Lord of hosts."

Even our abilities and opportunities come from Him.

Deuteronomy 8:18

"But thou shalt remember the Lord thy God: for it is he that giveth thee power to get wealth."

Understanding God's ownership produces humility because we realize that everything we have is a gift from Him.

Reflection

When we acknowledge God as Owner, we stop asking, "How can I use my resources for myself?" and begin asking, "How can I use God's resources for His glory?"

3. Humanity's Role as Managers

While God is the Owner, humanity has been appointed as managers.

Genesis 1:28

"Be fruitful, and multiply, and replenish the earth, and subdue it: and have dominion."

God entrusted mankind with the responsibility of caring for His creation.

This dominion was not permission to exploit creation but a command to manage it wisely and responsibly.

As God's representatives on earth, believers are called to:

- Manage resources wisely.
- Care for creation.
- Use talents productively.
- Serve others faithfully.
- Advance God's kingdom.

Illustration

A property manager may oversee a large estate, but the property does not belong to him. Likewise, we may possess houses, businesses, ministries, finances, and influence, but we are only caretakers of what belongs to God.

4. Areas of Stewardship

Stewardship affects every area of life.

A. Stewardship of Time

Time is one of God's most valuable gifts.

Each day God gives us twenty-four hours to serve Him, fulfil our responsibilities, and accomplish His purposes.

Ephesians 5:16

"Redeeming the time."

Faithful stewards use time wisely and avoid wasting opportunities.

B. Stewardship of Talents and Gifts

Every believer has received abilities and spiritual gifts.

1 Peter 4:10

"As every man hath received the gift, even so minister the same one to another."

God expects us to develop and use our gifts for the benefit of others and the glory of God.

C. Stewardship of Finances

Money is a tool entrusted to us by God.

How we earn, spend, save, give, and manage money reveals our spiritual priorities.

Luke 16:11

"If therefore ye have not been faithful in the unrighteous mammon, how will ye commit to your trust the true riches?"

D. Stewardship of Relationships

God entrusts people into our lives.

We are responsible for treating others with love, respect, and integrity.

E. Stewardship of Ministry Opportunities

Every opportunity to serve God is a sacred trust.

Whether preaching, teaching, singing, counselling, or helping others, believers are called to serve faithfully.

5. The Principle of Accountability

One of the most serious aspects of stewardship is accountability.

Stewards are responsible for how they manage what has been entrusted to them.

Romans 14:12

"So then every one of us shall give account of himself to God."

Every believer will one day answer to God regarding:

- Time used or wasted.
- Talents developed or neglected.
- Resources managed or misused.
- Opportunities embraced or ignored.

This truth should inspire careful and faithful living.

The Parable of the Talents

In Matthew 25:14–30, Jesus tells of servants entrusted with different amounts of money. When the master returned, each servant had to give an account.

The faithful servants were rewarded because they used what they had received wisely. The unfaithful servant was judged because he neglected his responsibility.

Lesson

God does not expect equal results from everyone, but He does expect faithfulness from everyone.

6. The Characteristics of a Faithful Steward

A faithful steward demonstrates certain qualities.

Faithfulness

A steward consistently obeys God and fulfils responsibilities.

1 Corinthians 4:2

"It is required in stewards that a man be found faithful."

Integrity

A steward acts honestly even when no one is watching.

Proverbs 10:9

"He that walketh uprightly walketh surely."

Responsibility

A steward takes ownership of assigned duties and fulfils them diligently.

Humility

A steward remembers that all success comes from God.

James 4:10

"Humble yourselves in the sight of the Lord."

Obedience

A steward follows the instructions of the Owner.

John 14:15

"If ye love me, keep my commandments."

Benefits of Understanding Stewardship

When believers understand stewardship:

- They become more faithful in serving God.
- They develop contentment and gratitude.
- They avoid pride and selfishness.
- They use resources wisely.
- They honour God in every area of life.
- They prepare for eternal rewards.

Practical Applications

1. Acknowledge daily that everything belongs to God.
2. Evaluate how you use your time each week.
3. Identify gifts and talents God has given you.
4. Manage finances responsibly and honestly.
5. Serve faithfully in every ministry assignment.
6. Remember that you will one day give an account to God.

Discussion Questions

1. What is the difference between ownership and stewardship?
2. Why is recognizing God's ownership important?
3. What resources has God entrusted to you?
4. How does accountability affect the way we live?
5. What qualities characterize a faithful steward?

Chapter Summary

Biblical stewardship begins with the recognition that God owns everything and believers are merely managers of His resources. God has entrusted us with time, talents, finances, relationships, opportunities, and ministry responsibilities. As stewards, we are accountable to

Him and are called to manage His gifts faithfully, responsibly, and for His glory. Faithfulness—not ownership—is the true measure of a successful steward.

Key Lesson

God owns everything, and we are accountable stewards entrusted with managing His resources faithfully for His glory and kingdom purposes.

Chapter 2: Stewardship of Time

Time is one of the most valuable resources God has given to every person. Unlike money, possessions, or opportunities, time cannot be stored, recovered, or replaced once it has passed. Every person is given the same twenty-four hours in a day, yet the difference between a fruitful life and an unproductive one often lies in how that time is used.

God has entrusted each believer with a limited number of days on earth. Therefore, time must be viewed as a sacred gift and a divine responsibility. Every moment presents an opportunity to worship God, serve others, grow spiritually, fulfil our responsibilities, and advance God's kingdom.

Many people waste time through procrastination, distractions, laziness, and poor planning. However, faithful stewards understand that every day is a gift from God and seek to use it wisely for His glory.

The stewardship of time is not about being busy all the time; it is about being productive in the things that matter most to God.

1. Understanding Time as a Gift from God

Time is part of God's provision for humanity. Every day we live is evidence of God's grace and mercy.

Psalm 90:12

"Teach us to number our days, that we may apply our hearts unto wisdom."

Moses prayed for wisdom to understand the brevity and value of life. This verse teaches that when we recognize our days are limited, we become more careful about how we spend them.

Many people live as if they have unlimited time, postponing important decisions, delaying obedience, and neglecting their spiritual growth. Wise stewards understand that life is short and every day should be used purposefully.

James 4:14

Why, you do not even know what will happen tomorrow. What is your life? You are a mist that appears for a little while and then vanishes.

Because life is temporary, believers should make every day count.

Key Truth

Time is a gift from God that should be invested wisely, not wasted carelessly.

2. Making the Most of Every Opportunity

Ephesians 5:15–16

"See then that ye walk circumspectly, not as fools, but as wise, redeeming the time, because the days are evil."

The phrase "redeeming the time" means making the best use of every opportunity. It involves using available moments wisely for God's purposes.

Wise believers:

- Recognize opportunities to serve.
- Prioritize meaningful activities.
- Avoid wasting time.
- Use each day intentionally.

Foolish people often:

- Delay important tasks.
- Spend excessive time on distractions.
- Neglect spiritual responsibilities.
- Live without purpose.

Illustration

A farmer understands that planting must be done during the proper season. If he wastes the planting season, he may lose the harvest. Likewise, believers must recognize and use the opportunities God provides before they pass.

Application

Ask yourself daily:

- Am I spending time on what truly matters?
- Am I investing in eternal things or only temporary things?

3. Understanding God's Timing

Ecclesiastes 3:1

"To everything there is a season, and a time to every purpose under the heaven."

God operates according to seasons and timing. Just as nature has seasons, life also has seasons.

There is:

- A season to learn.
- A season to work.
- A season to build.
- A season to serve.
- A season to rest.
- A season to harvest.

Faithful stewards understand the importance of recognizing God's timing and responding appropriately.

Problems arise when people try to force things before their time or neglect responsibilities during the proper season.

Example

Joseph endured years of preparation before becoming ruler in Egypt. Although God's promise was certain, Joseph had to wait for God's appointed time.

Lesson

Wisdom includes knowing not only what to do but also when to do it.

4. Prioritizing God First

Matthew 6:33

"But seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you."

One of the greatest principles of time stewardship is proper prioritization.

God must be first in our schedules, decisions, and daily activities.

Many people claim God is important but give Him only leftover time after everything else has been done.

Faithful stewards intentionally make time for:

- Prayer
- Bible study
- Worship
- Fellowship
- Ministry service

When God becomes the highest priority, every other area of life becomes more balanced and productive.

Practical Ways to Put God First

- Begin each day with prayer.
- Read Scripture daily.
- Attend church faithfully.
- Serve in ministry.
- Seek God's guidance before making decisions.

Key Principle

When God is first in our lives, everything else finds its proper place.

5. Avoiding Laziness and Procrastination

One of the greatest enemies of good time stewardship is laziness.

Proverbs 6:6

"Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise."

The ant works diligently and prepares for the future without needing constant supervision.

Lazy people often:

- Delay important tasks.
- Make excuses.
- Waste opportunities.
- Depend on others unnecessarily.

Proverbs 13:4

"The soul of the sluggard desireth, and hath nothing: but the soul of the diligent shall be made fat."

Procrastination is another form of poor stewardship. Delaying necessary action often creates unnecessary problems.

Common Causes of Procrastination

- Fear of failure
- Lack of discipline
- Poor planning
- Distractions
- Perfectionism

Overcoming Procrastination

- Set clear goals.
- Start immediately.
- Break large tasks into smaller steps.
- Maintain discipline.
- Depend on God's help.

6. Planning and Organization

Faithful stewardship requires planning.

Proverbs 21:5

The plans of the diligent lead to profit as surely as haste leads to poverty."

Planning helps believers:

- Use time effectively.
- Avoid confusion.
- Meet responsibilities.
- Accomplish goals.
- Reduce stress.

Jesus Himself demonstrated planning and intentionality throughout His earthly ministry.

Practical Planning Tools

- Daily schedules
- Weekly plans
- Ministry calendars
- Goal setting
- Priority lists

Important Principle

Planning does not replace dependence on God; it helps us manage responsibilities wisely.

7. Balancing Life's Responsibilities

God expects believers to manage multiple responsibilities.

These include:

Spiritual Responsibilities

- Prayer
- Bible study
- Worship
- Evangelism

Family Responsibilities

- Marriage
- Parenting
- Family care

Work Responsibilities

- Employment
- Business
- Professional duties

Ministry Responsibilities

- Church service
- Leadership
- Discipleship

Poor stewardship occurs when one area consumes all attention while other important responsibilities are neglected.

Example

A person may be active in church ministry but neglect family responsibilities. Another may focus entirely on work while neglecting spiritual growth.

Faithful stewards seek balance under God's guidance.

8. Investing Time in Eternal Priorities

Not everything that is urgent is important.

Wise believers invest time in activities that produce eternal value.

Colossians 3:2

"Set your affection on things above, not on things on the earth."

Eternal investments include:

- Leading people to Christ.
- Discipling believers.
- Studying God's Word.
- Prayer.
- Serving others.
- Building godly relationships.

Many temporary activities consume time but produce little lasting fruit.

Reflection

At the end of life, people rarely regret spending too much time serving God, loving family, or helping others. They often regret wasted opportunities and neglected priorities.

Characteristics of a Good Time Steward

A faithful steward of time:

- Values every day as a gift from God.
- Lives purposefully.
- Prioritizes God first.
- Avoids laziness and procrastination.
- Plans wisely.
- Maintains balance.
- Invests in eternal things.
- Uses opportunities for God's glory.

Practical Applications

1. Begin each day with prayer and Scripture reading.
2. Create a daily schedule and follow it.
3. Identify and eliminate time-wasting habits.
4. Set spiritual, family, and ministry goals.
5. Complete important tasks promptly.
6. Evaluate weekly how your time was spent.
7. Invest more time in activities with eternal value.

Discussion Questions

1. Why is time considered one of God's greatest gifts?
2. What does it mean to redeem the time?
3. What are some common ways people waste time?
4. How can believers put God first in their schedules?
5. What practical steps can help improve time management?
6. How can a person balance family, work, and ministry responsibilities?

Chapter Summary

Time is a precious gift entrusted to us by God. Since life is temporary, believers must use their time wisely by seeking God first, recognizing opportunities, avoiding laziness, planning effectively, and maintaining balance in their responsibilities. Faithful stewards understand that every day is an opportunity to glorify God and advance His kingdom. They invest their time in things that have lasting spiritual value and seek to make every moment count for eternity.

Key Lesson

Faithful stewards value their time as a gift from God and use it wisely to fulfil His purposes, serve others, and advance His kingdom.

Chapter 3: Stewardship of Talents and Gifts

God has uniquely designed every believer and entrusted each person with talents, abilities, and spiritual gifts. These gifts are not given for personal glory, competition, or self-promotion, but for serving others and advancing God's Kingdom. No believer is without a gift, and no gift is insignificant in God's eyes.

Just as different parts of the human body perform different functions, believers have different gifts and responsibilities within the Body of Christ. Some are called to teach, others to lead, encourage, serve, give, organize, sing, evangelize, or show mercy. When every believer faithfully uses their God-given gifts, the church grows stronger and God's purposes are fulfilled.

Unfortunately, many believers either neglect their gifts, underestimate them, misuse them, or compare themselves to others. God expects His children to discover, develop, and diligently use what He has entrusted to them.

The question is not whether you have a gift, but whether you are using it faithfully.

1. Understanding Talents and Spiritual Gifts

Although talents and spiritual gifts are related, they are not exactly the same.

Talents

Talents are natural abilities God has given a person.

Examples include:

- Singing
- Writing
- Leadership
- Teaching
- Administration
- Art and design
- Communication
- Business skills
- Technology skills

These abilities may be present from childhood and can be developed through learning and practice.

Spiritual Gifts

Spiritual gifts are special abilities given by the Holy Spirit to believers for ministry and service.

Examples include:

- Teaching
- Prophecy
- Encouragement
- Leadership
- Giving
- Mercy
- Evangelism
- Pastoring

Romans 12:6

"We have different gifts, according to the grace given to each of us."

God distributes gifts according to His wisdom and purpose.

Key Truth

Every believer has something valuable to contribute to God's Kingdom.

2. God Is the Source of Every Gift

All gifts originate from God.

James 1:17

"Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, and cometh down from the Father of lights."

No talent, ability, intelligence, opportunity, or spiritual gift is self-created. Everything we possess has been given by God.

Understanding this truth produces:

- Humility
- Gratitude
- Dependence on God

Pride develops when people forget the source of their abilities and begin to take credit for what God has provided.

1 Corinthians 4:7

"What hast thou that thou didst not receive?"

Lesson

Because God is the source of every gift, He deserves all the glory.

3. Every Gift Has Value

Many believers wrongly believe that only visible gifts are important. However, Scripture teaches that every gift has value.

1 Corinthians 12:18

"God hath set the members every one of them in the body, as it hath pleased him."

Some gifts are public, while others operate behind the scenes.

Visible Gifts

- Preaching
- Teaching
- Worship leading
- Evangelism

Less Visible Gifts

- Administration
- Hospitality
- Encouragement
- Prayer ministry
- Service and helps

Both categories are equally important.

Illustration

The heart is rarely seen, but it is essential to life. Likewise, many people serving quietly behind the scenes play vital roles in God's Kingdom.

Key Principle

God measures faithfulness, not visibility.

4. Discovering Your Gifts

Many believers never discover their gifts because they never seek God's direction or become involved in serving.

Ways to Discover Your Gifts

A. Pray for God's Guidance

Ask God to reveal the gifts and abilities He has placed within you.

James 1:5

"If any of you lack wisdom, let him ask of God."

B. Study God's Word

The Bible identifies various spiritual gifts and ministry functions.

Relevant passages include:

- Romans 12:3–8
- 1 Corinthians 12
- Ephesians 4:11–12
- 1 Peter 4:10–11

C. Begin Serving

Many gifts are discovered through practical ministry involvement.

As you serve:

- Your strengths become evident.
- Others recognize your effectiveness.
- Opportunities for growth emerge.

D. Seek Wise Counsel

Church leaders and mature believers can often identify gifts you may not recognize in yourself.

Proverbs 15:22

"In the multitude of counsellors they are established."

5. Developing Your Gifts

Possessing a gift is only the beginning. Gifts must be developed through practice, learning, and diligence.

2 Timothy 1:6

"Fan into flame the gift of God."

Paul encouraged Timothy not to neglect his gift but to develop and strengthen it.

Ways to Develop Your Gifts

Study and Training

Learn from Scripture, mentors, and educational resources.

Practice Regularly

Growth comes through consistent use.

Accept Correction

Constructive feedback helps improve effectiveness.

Remain Teachable

The most effective servants are lifelong learners.

Illustration

A seed contains great potential, but unless it is planted, watered, and nurtured, it will never reach maturity.

Lesson

Unused gifts remain undeveloped gifts.

6. Using Gifts to Serve Others

1 Peter 4:10

"Use whatever gift you have received to serve others, as faithful stewards of God's grace."

The purpose of spiritual gifts is service.

God did not give gifts merely for personal benefit but for helping others and building His church.

Ways Gifts Serve Others

- Teaching brings understanding.
- Encouragement brings hope.
- Leadership provides direction.
- Giving meets needs.
- Mercy brings comfort.
- Evangelism brings salvation.

A gift reaches its highest purpose when it blesses others.

Key Principle

Gifts are tools for service, not trophies for display.

7. The Danger of Neglecting Gifts

Many believers possess gifts that remain unused.

Matthew 25:25

In the Parable of the Talents, one servant buried what had been entrusted to him.

The master rebuked him for failing to use his opportunity.

Reasons People Neglect Their Gifts

- Fear
- Laziness
- Lack of confidence
- Comparison with others
- Discouragement
- Lack of commitment

Neglected gifts fail to produce fruit and blessings.

Lesson

God expects believers to use what He has entrusted to them.

8. Avoiding Comparison and Competition

One of the greatest enemies of effective stewardship is comparison.

Galatians 6:4

"Let every man prove his own work."

Believers should focus on their own assignments rather than comparing themselves to others.

Comparison often leads to:

- Jealousy
- Pride
- Discouragement
- Competition

God never intended all believers to have the same gifts.

Romans 12:6

"We have different gifts according to the grace given to each of us."

Important Truth

Your value is not determined by the type of gift you possess but by your faithfulness in using it.

9. The Principle of Growth and Multiplication

Matthew 25:29

"For unto every one that hath shall be given."

God often increases opportunities for those who faithfully use what they already have.

Faithfulness leads to:

- Greater influence
- Greater opportunities
- Greater responsibility
- Greater effectiveness

The believer who uses their gift grows stronger, while neglected gifts often become ineffective.

Principle

Use it or lose it.

Characteristics of a Faithful Steward of Gifts

A faithful steward:

- Recognizes God as the source of every gift.
- Appreciates the value of all gifts.
- Seeks to discover God's purpose.
- Develops abilities diligently.
- Uses gifts to serve others.
- Avoids pride and comparison.
- Remains teachable.
- Gives God the glory.

Practical Applications

1. Identify gifts and talents God has given you.
2. Begin serving where opportunities exist.
3. Seek training and development.
4. Ask trusted leaders for feedback.
5. Avoid comparing yourself to others.
6. Commit to using your gifts consistently.
7. Give God glory for every success.

Discussion Questions

1. What is the difference between a natural talent and a spiritual gift?
2. Why does God give different gifts to different people?
3. How can a believer discover their gifts?
4. What happens when gifts are neglected?
5. Why is comparison dangerous?
6. How can gifts be developed and strengthened?

Summary

God has given every believer unique talents, abilities, and spiritual gifts for the purpose of serving others and glorifying Him. Since God is the source of every gift, believers must use them with humility and gratitude. Faithful stewards discover, develop, and diligently use their gifts rather than neglecting them. When gifts are properly used, the church is strengthened, lives are transformed, and God receives glory.

Key Lesson

Every gift from God is valuable and should be faithfully developed and used to serve others, build God's Kingdom, and bring glory to Him.

Chapter 4: Stewardship of Financial Resources

Money and material possessions are among the resources God entrusts to His people. While finances are necessary for daily living, the Bible teaches that money is more than a means of exchange—it is a test of character, faithfulness, and priorities. The way believers earn, spend, save, give, and manage their finances reveals much about their relationship with God.

Financial stewardship is not measured by how much a person possesses but by how faithfully they manage what they have. Whether a person has little or much, God expects wisdom, honesty, responsibility, and generosity. Throughout Scripture, God provides principles for managing resources in ways that honour Him and advance His Kingdom.

Many financial problems arise not because of a lack of resources but because of poor stewardship. God desires His people to become faithful managers who use financial resources for His glory and the blessing of others.

1. Understanding God's Ownership of Wealth

The foundation of financial stewardship begins with recognizing that God owns everything.

Psalm 24:1

"The earth is the Lord's, and everything in it."

Everything we possess ultimately belongs to God.

- Our income belongs to God.
- Our property belongs to God.
- Our businesses belong to God.
- Our investments belong to God.
- Our possessions belong to God.

We are not owners but stewards entrusted with God's resources.

Deuteronomy 8:18

"Remember the Lord your God, for it is He who gives you the ability to produce wealth."

Even the skills, opportunities, strength, and knowledge used to earn money come from God.

Key Truth

God is the Owner; we are the managers.

2. Earning Money Honestly

God desires believers to acquire resources through honest and honourable means.

Proverbs 13:11

"Wealth gained hastily will dwindle, but whoever gathers little by little will increase it."

The Bible condemns:

- Fraud
- Theft
- Corruption
- Dishonesty
- Exploitation
- Bribery

Instead, believers are encouraged to work diligently and honestly.

Colossians 3:23

"Whatever you do, work heartily, as for the Lord and not for men."

Characteristics of Honest Earning

- Integrity in business
- Fair treatment of others
- Truthfulness in transactions
- Excellence in work
- Dependability

Lesson

God blesses honest labour more than dishonest gain.

3. Faithfulness in Small Things

Luke 16:10

"Whoever can be trusted with very little can also be trusted with much."

One of God's principles is that faithfulness in small matters prepares a person for greater responsibility.

Many people pray for financial increase while neglecting proper management of what they already have.

Faithfulness includes:

- Paying bills on time.
- Keeping financial records.
- Managing resources carefully.
- Avoiding waste.
- Honouring commitments.

Principle

God often tests our stewardship before increasing our resources.

4. Honouring God with Our Wealth

Proverbs 3:9

"Honour the Lord with your wealth and with the first fruits of all your increase."

Financial stewardship begins by placing God first.

Many people spend money on everything else and give God whatever remains. Scripture teaches the opposite principle.

Honouring God with wealth means:

- Recognizing Him as the source.
- Giving Him priority.
- Using finances according to His purposes.
- Avoiding greed and selfishness.

Practical Ways to Honour God Financially

- Support God's work.
- Help those in need.
- Practice honesty.
- Avoid wasteful spending.
- Maintain a generous spirit.

Key Principle

Where God is honoured, His blessing often follows.

5. The Principle of Tithing

Malachi 3:10

"Bring the whole tithe into the storehouse."

The tithe refers to giving a tenth of one's increase to God.

Throughout Scripture, tithing is presented as an act of:

- Worship
- Obedience
- Faith
- Gratitude

Tithing reminds believers that everything belongs to God and that He is their provider.

Benefits of Tithing

- Demonstrates trust in God.
- Supports the work of ministry.
- Develops financial discipline.
- Breaks the power of greed.
- Expresses gratitude to God.

Important Note

Tithing should never be viewed as a burden but as an opportunity to honour God.

6. The Ministry of Generous Giving

2 Corinthians 9:7

"God loves a cheerful giver."

Beyond tithing, believers are encouraged to practice generosity.

Generous giving reflects the character of God, who freely gives to His children.

Areas of Generosity

- Supporting church ministry
- Helping the poor
- Assisting widows and orphans
- Supporting missionaries
- Meeting urgent needs
- Blessing others

Characteristics of Biblical Giving

Willing

Giving should come from the heart.

Cheerful

Giving should be done with joy.

Sacrificial

Sometimes generosity requires personal sacrifice.

Faith-Filled

Giving demonstrates trust in God's provision.

Acts 20:35

"It is more blessed to give than to receive."

7. Wise Spending

Faithful stewardship involves careful and responsible spending.

Proverbs 21:20

"The wise store up choice food and olive oil, but fools gulp theirs down."

Many financial difficulties result from poor spending habits rather than insufficient income.

Principles of Wise Spending

- Distinguish needs from wants.
- Avoid impulsive purchases.
- Live within your means.
- Plan purchases carefully.
- Seek God's guidance.

Questions Before Spending

- Is this necessary?
- Will this honor God?
- Can I afford it?
- Is this the best use of my resources?

Lesson

Wise spending reflects disciplined stewardship.

8. Saving and Planning for the Future

The Bible encourages prudent preparation.

Proverbs 6:6–8

"Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise."

The ant gathers and stores resources for future needs.

Saving demonstrates:

- Wisdom
- Responsibility
- Foresight
- Discipline

Reasons for Saving

- Emergencies
- Future goals
- Family responsibilities
- Ministry opportunities

Balance

While saving is wise, believers should avoid trusting money more than God.

Key Principle

Save responsibly while trusting God completely.

9. Avoiding Unnecessary Debt

Debt can create financial pressure and limit opportunities.

Proverbs 22:7

"The borrower is servant to the lender."

Although not all debt is sinful, unnecessary debt can become a burden.

Causes of Excessive Debt

- Impulse buying
- Poor planning
- Greed
- Lack of contentment
- Living beyond one's means

Biblical Financial Wisdom

- Borrow cautiously.
- Repay debts promptly.

- Avoid unnecessary obligations.
- Practice contentment.

Romans 13:8

"Owe no man anything, but to love one another."

10. Guarding Against Greed and Materialism

One of the greatest dangers in financial stewardship is allowing money to become an idol.

Matthew 6:24

"You cannot serve God and mammon."

Money is a useful servant but a terrible master.

Signs of Materialism

- Constant dissatisfaction
- Obsession with wealth
- Neglect of spiritual priorities
- Excessive focus on possessions

1 Timothy 6:10

"The love of money is the root of all kinds of evil."

The Bible does not condemn money itself but warns against loving it more than God.

Lesson

God desires us to possess resources without allowing resources to possess us.

Financial Stewardship in Church Ministry

Church workers and leaders have a special responsibility to model financial integrity.

Responsibilities Include

- Accountability in handling church funds.
- Transparency in financial matters.
- Avoiding misuse of ministry resources.
- Maintaining accurate records.
- Demonstrating generosity.

1 Corinthians 4:2

"It is required in stewards that a man be found faithful."

Faithfulness in finances strengthens trust and protects the testimony of the church.

Characteristics of a Faithful Financial Steward

A faithful financial steward:

- Recognizes God as Owner.
- Earns honestly.
- Honours God first.
- Tithes faithfully.
- Gives generously.
- Spends wisely.
- Saves responsibly.
- Avoids unnecessary debt.
- Lives with contentment.
- Uses resources for God's glory.

Practical Applications

1. Create and follow a monthly budget.
2. Commit to honouring God with your finances.
3. Practice regular tithing and generous giving.
4. Reduce unnecessary spending.
5. Establish a savings plan.
6. Avoid taking on unnecessary debt.
7. Review your financial habits regularly.
8. Use resources to bless others and advance God's Kingdom.

Discussion Questions

1. Why is financial stewardship important to God?
2. What does it mean to honour God with your wealth?
3. How does tithing demonstrate faith and obedience?
4. What are the dangers of excessive debt?
5. How can believers guard against materialism?
6. What practical steps can improve financial stewardship?

Summary

Financial resources are gifts entrusted to believers by God. Since God is the Owner of all things, believers are called to manage money with wisdom, integrity, and faithfulness. Good stewardship involves earning honestly, honouring God first, tithing faithfully, giving generously, spending wisely, saving responsibly, and avoiding unnecessary debt. Faithful financial stewardship not only brings stability and blessing but also advances God's Kingdom and reflects a heart that trusts God above material possessions.

Key Lesson

God expects believers to manage financial resources faithfully by earning honestly, giving generously, spending wisely, and using every resource for His glory and Kingdom purposes.

Chapter 5: Stewardship of Opportunities

Overview

Life is filled with opportunities that God places before His people. These opportunities may come in the form of ministry assignments, acts of service, relationships, education, employment, leadership positions, witnessing opportunities, or moments to help those in need. Every opportunity carries the potential to fulfil God's purposes and bring glory to His name.

Many people pray for opportunities, yet when opportunities come, they fail to recognize them or delay responding until it is too late. The Bible teaches that opportunities are gifts from God and must be managed wisely. Just as we are stewards of time, talents, and finances, we are also stewards of opportunities.

Faithful believers understand that opportunities often come disguised as responsibilities, challenges, or simple acts of obedience. They remain spiritually alert, sensitive to God's leading, and willing to act when God opens a door.

A missed opportunity may never return, while a seized opportunity can change lives, impact generations, and advance God's Kingdom.

1. Understanding Opportunities as Gifts from God

Opportunities do not happen by accident. God, in His sovereignty, opens doors and creates circumstances through which His purposes can be fulfilled.

Revelation 3:8

"See, I have placed before you an open door that no one can shut."

Throughout Scripture, God presented opportunities to individuals and nations.

Examples include:

- Noah's opportunity to build the ark.
- Moses' opportunity to lead Israel.
- Esther's opportunity to save her people.
- David's opportunity to defeat Goliath.
- Paul's opportunity to preach the Gospel to the Gentiles.

Each person faced a choice: embrace the opportunity or ignore it.

Key Truth

Every God-given opportunity is a responsibility that should be handled faithfully.

2. Recognizing Opportunities

Many opportunities are missed because people fail to recognize them.

Galatians 6:10

"As we have therefore opportunity, let us do good unto all men."

Paul teaches believers to be alert to opportunities for doing good.

Opportunities often appear as:

- A chance to serve.
- A person in need.
- A ministry assignment.
- A leadership responsibility.
- A learning experience.
- A challenge requiring faith.

Unfortunately, some people expect opportunities to arrive in dramatic ways and fail to recognize ordinary moments that God can use for extraordinary purposes.

Example

The Good Samaritan recognized an opportunity to help an injured man when others passed by. His compassion transformed a simple moment into a lasting example of godly stewardship.

Lesson

Spiritual sensitivity helps believers recognize opportunities that others overlook.

3. Making the Most of Every Opportunity

Colossians 4:5

"Walk in wisdom toward them that are without, redeeming the time."

The phrase "making the most of every opportunity" means taking full advantage of opportunities God provides.

Faithful stewards:

- Act promptly.
- Remain prepared.
- Respond with wisdom.

- Avoid unnecessary delays.

Many opportunities are time-sensitive. Delayed obedience can become disobedience.

Illustration

A farmer who refuses to plant during planting season may miss the harvest. Likewise, opportunities often have a limited window and require immediate action.

Key Principle

Opportunities are valuable because they do not last forever.

4. Opportunities to Serve Others

One of the greatest opportunities God gives believers is the opportunity to serve.

Galatians 6:10

"Let us do good unto all men, especially unto them who are of the household of faith."

Service opportunities may include:

- Helping the needy.
- Encouraging the discouraged.
- Visiting the sick.
- Supporting ministry.
- Mentoring others.
- Assisting church projects.

Jesus consistently used opportunities to serve people.

Mark 10:45

"For even the Son of man came not to be ministered unto, but to minister."

Faithful stewards do not wait for perfect circumstances; they serve whenever opportunities arise.

5. Opportunities to Share the Gospel

One of the most important opportunities believers receive is the opportunity to witness.

Matthew 28:19

"Go ye therefore, and teach all nations."

Every day presents opportunities to:

- Share personal testimonies.

- Invite others to church.
- Explain the message of salvation.
- Pray with those in need.
- Demonstrate Christ's love.

Many people may only have one opportunity to hear the Gospel.

Romans 10:14

"How shall they hear without a preacher?"

Lesson

Faithful stewards seize opportunities to lead others closer to Christ.

6. Opportunities for Growth and Learning

God often provides opportunities to grow spiritually, emotionally, intellectually, and professionally.

Proverbs 1:5

"A wise man will hear, and will increase learning."

Growth opportunities include:

- Bible study.
- Training programs.
- Mentorship.
- Conferences and seminars.
- Educational advancement.
- Ministry experience.

Some people reject opportunities because they require effort, sacrifice, or change.

Wise believers understand that growth often comes through challenges.

Example

Timothy grew into ministry leadership because he embraced opportunities to learn from Paul.

Key Principle

Every opportunity to learn is an opportunity to improve future effectiveness.

7. Opportunities Hidden in Challenges

Not all opportunities appear pleasant at first.

Many of God's greatest opportunities come disguised as difficulties.

Romans 8:28

"All things work together for good to them that love God."

Examples:

- Joseph's imprisonment became an opportunity for promotion.
- David's battle with Goliath became an opportunity for advancement.
- Paul's imprisonment became an opportunity to spread the Gospel.

Challenges often:

- Build character.
- Strengthen faith.
- Develop leadership.
- Reveal hidden potential.

Lesson

Faithful stewards learn to see possibilities where others only see problems.

8. Working Diligently While Opportunities Remain

John 9:4

"We must do the works of him that sent me, while it is day: the night cometh, when no man can work."

Jesus emphasized urgency.

Opportunities are not permanent.

There are seasons for:

- Serving
- Learning
- Witnessing
- Building
- Giving
- Growing

When these seasons pass, the opportunities may be gone.

Ecclesiastes 9:10

"Whatever your hand finds to do, do it with all your might."

God expects believers to work diligently while opportunities exist.

Important Principle

The best time to obey God is now.

9. Common Reasons People Miss Opportunities

Fear

Fear of failure often prevents action.

Proverbs 29:25

"The fear of man bringeth a snare."

Procrastination

Waiting too long causes many opportunities to disappear.

Lack of Preparation

Unprepared people often miss open doors.

Laziness

Some opportunities require effort and sacrifice.

Disobedience

Ignoring God's direction often results in missed blessings.

Lesson

Faithfulness requires courage, readiness, and action.

10. The Rewards of Seizing Opportunities

When believers faithfully respond to opportunities:

God Is Glorified

Lives reflect His goodness and power.

Others Are Blessed

People receive help, encouragement, and salvation.

Character Is Developed

Faith grows through obedience.

Greater Opportunities Follow

Faithfulness in small opportunities often leads to larger responsibilities.

Matthew 25:21

"Well done, good and faithful servant."

Key Truth

God often entrusts greater opportunities to those who faithfully use smaller ones.

Characteristics of a Faithful Steward of Opportunities

A faithful steward:

- Remains spiritually alert.
- Recognizes God's open doors.
- Acts promptly.
- Serves willingly.
- Shares the Gospel boldly.
- Embraces growth opportunities.
- Perseveres through challenges.
- Works diligently.
- Trusts God's timing.
- Uses every opportunity for God's glory.

Practical Applications

1. Pray daily for wisdom to recognize opportunities.
2. Be willing to serve whenever needs arise.
3. Share your faith when opportunities present themselves.
4. Take advantage of learning and training opportunities.
5. Stop delaying important actions.
6. View challenges as potential opportunities.
7. Act quickly when God opens a door.
8. Evaluate each day for opportunities you used or missed.

Discussion Questions

1. What is a God-given opportunity?
2. Why do many people fail to recognize opportunities?
3. How can believers make the most of every opportunity?
4. What opportunities has God recently placed before you?
5. How can challenges become opportunities?
6. Why is urgency important in stewardship?

Summary

God continually provides opportunities for believers to serve, witness, grow, learn, and bless others. These opportunities are valuable gifts that must be recognized and used before they pass. Faithful stewards remain spiritually alert, act promptly, and respond obediently when

God opens doors. Whether opportunities come through ministry, relationships, service, learning, or challenges, believers are called to use them for God's glory and the advancement of His Kingdom.

Key Lesson

Faithful stewards recognize, embrace, and maximize God-given opportunities to serve others, grow spiritually, advance God's Kingdom, and bring glory to Him.

Throughout this study, we have learned that stewardship involves faithfully managing everything God has entrusted to us—our time, talents, finances, opportunities, relationships, and responsibilities. Stewardship is not merely about managing resources; it is about honouring God through faithful obedience.

One of the greatest motivations for faithful stewardship is the assurance that God sees, values, and rewards faithfulness. While people often reward success, popularity, or achievement, God rewards faithfulness. The Bible repeatedly teaches that no act of obedience, sacrifice, service, or generosity done for God is ever overlooked.

Many faithful believers may never receive recognition on earth. Their service may go unnoticed by others, but God keeps a perfect record. He sees every prayer prayed, every sacrifice made, every gift given, every soul reached, and every act of service performed in His name.

The ultimate goal of stewardship is not earthly recognition but hearing the words of Christ:

Matthew 25:21

"Well done, good and faithful servant."

This chapter explores the blessings and rewards that accompany faithful stewardship both in this life and in eternity.

1. God Rewards Faithfulness, Not Just Results

Matthew 25:21

"Well done, good and faithful servant; thou hast been faithful over a few things, I will make thee ruler over many things."

In the Parable of the Talents, the master rewarded his servants because they were faithful with what had been entrusted to them.

Notice that the reward was based on faithfulness rather than comparison.

God does not expect every believer to have the same:

- Position

- Influence
- Resources
- Opportunities
- Results

However, He does expect every believer to be faithful with what they have received.

Key Truth

God measures faithfulness, not fame.

Lesson

Success in God's eyes is faithfully fulfilling His purpose for your life.

2. Faithfulness in Small Things Leads to Greater Responsibility

Luke 16:10

"Whoever is faithful in very little is faithful also in much."

One of God's principles is that faithfulness in small responsibilities prepares a person for greater opportunities.

Many believers desire greater influence, leadership, and blessings but neglect smaller responsibilities.

Examples of small areas of stewardship include:

- Managing personal finances.
- Serving in simple ministry tasks.
- Keeping commitments.
- Arriving on time.
- Caring for church property.
- Helping others quietly.

God often tests character through small assignments before entrusting larger responsibilities.

Biblical Examples

Joseph

Joseph faithfully served as a slave and prisoner before becoming governor of Egypt.

David

David faithfully cared for sheep before becoming king.

Timothy

Timothy faithfully served under Paul before becoming a respected church leader.

Principle

Small acts of faithfulness prepare us for greater Kingdom assignments.

3. The Reward of Spiritual Growth

Faithful stewardship produces spiritual maturity.

As believers consistently obey God, they develop:

- Stronger faith
- Greater wisdom
- Better character
- Increased humility
- Deeper trust in God

James 1:3–4

"The testing of your faith produces perseverance."

Every act of faithful stewardship shapes the believer into the image of Christ.

Areas of Growth

Growth in Character

Faithfulness develops integrity and discipline.

Growth in Faith

Trusting God with resources strengthens confidence in Him.

Growth in Wisdom

Wise stewardship increases spiritual understanding.

Growth in Dependence on God

Faithful stewards learn that success comes from God rather than personal ability.

Lesson

One of God's greatest rewards is becoming more like Christ.

4. The Reward of Kingdom Impact

Faithful stewardship affects more than the individual believer.

It impacts families, churches, communities, and future generations.

Galatians 6:9

"Let us not grow weary in doing good, for at the proper time we will reap a harvest."

Examples of Kingdom impact include:

- Souls won to Christ.
- Disciples developed.
- Churches strengthened.
- Families transformed.
- Communities blessed.

Many believers may never fully see the results of their faithfulness during their lifetime.

However, God uses faithful stewardship to accomplish purposes that often extend far beyond what we can imagine.

Illustration

A seed planted today may produce fruit for many years. Likewise, acts of faithful stewardship often create lasting spiritual influence.

Principle

Faithfulness today can impact generations tomorrow.

5. The Joy of God's Approval

The greatest reward is not material blessing but God's approval.

Matthew 25:21

"Well done, good and faithful servant."

Every believer longs to hear these words from Christ.

Human praise is temporary, but God's approval is eternal.

Many people live seeking the approval of others, but faithful stewards seek first to please God.

Colossians 3:23

"Whatever you do, work heartily, as for the Lord."

Reflection

If no one else recognized your service, would you still serve faithfully for God alone?

Faithful stewards answer yes because they know God sees everything.

6. Eternal Rewards in Heaven

The Bible teaches that believers will one day stand before Christ to give an account of their stewardship.

Revelation 22:12

"Behold, I am coming quickly, and My reward is with Me."

This judgment is not about salvation but about rewards for faithful service.

2 Corinthians 5:10

"For we must all appear before the judgment seat of Christ."

God will evaluate:

- Motives
- Faithfulness
- Service
- Obedience
- Stewardship

Important Truth

Salvation is a gift received through faith, but rewards are granted according to faithfulness.

7. Rewards That Endure Forever

1 Corinthians 3:14

"If what has been built survives, the builder will receive a reward."

Many earthly accomplishments eventually disappear.

- Wealth fades.
- Possessions wear out.
- Fame is forgotten.

However, spiritual investments produce eternal rewards.

Eternal Investments Include

- Winning souls.
- Making disciples.
- Teaching God's Word.
- Supporting ministry.
- Helping others.

- Living faithfully.

These rewards cannot be destroyed by time or circumstances.

Matthew 6:20

"Lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven."

Principle

The wisest investment is one that lasts forever.

8. Avoiding the Loss of Reward

Although salvation is secure through Christ, believers can lose opportunities for reward through unfaithfulness.

1 Corinthians 3:15

"He himself shall be saved; yet so as by fire."

Examples of unfaithfulness include:

- Neglecting responsibilities.
- Wasting opportunities.
- Misusing resources.
- Serving with wrong motives.
- Living in disobedience.

God desires every believer to finish well and receive a full reward.

2 John 1:8

"Watch yourselves, that you do not lose what we have worked for."

Lesson

Faithfulness today protects rewards tomorrow.

9. Living with an Eternal Perspective

Faithful stewards understand that life on earth is temporary.

Colossians 3:2

"Set your affection on things above, not on things on the earth."

An eternal perspective changes priorities.

Instead of living only for:

- Comfort
- Possessions
- Status
- Personal gain

Believers begin living for:

- God's glory
- Kingdom advancement
- Eternal rewards
- Faithful service

Key Truth

People who live for eternity make different decisions than those who live only for today.

Characteristics of a Reward-Worthy Steward

A faithful steward:

- Remains faithful in small things.
- Serves without seeking recognition.
- Uses resources wisely.
- Perseveres through challenges.
- Invests in God's Kingdom.
- Seeks God's approval above human praise.
- Maintains an eternal perspective.
- Finishes the race faithfully.

Practical Applications

1. Evaluate your faithfulness in daily responsibilities.
2. Serve God even when no one notices.
3. Continue using your gifts and talents diligently.
4. Invest more time and resources in Kingdom work.
5. Focus on eternal values rather than temporary rewards.
6. Persevere through difficulties without giving up.
7. Live each day with eternity in mind.

Discussion Questions

1. Why does God reward faithfulness rather than worldly success?
2. How does faithfulness in small things prepare us for greater responsibilities?
3. What are some examples of eternal rewards?
4. Why is God's approval more important than human recognition?
5. How can believers live with an eternal perspective?
6. What areas of stewardship require greater faithfulness in your life?

Summary

God honours and rewards faithful stewardship. Whether managing time, talents, finances, opportunities, or ministry responsibilities, believers are called to serve faithfully and obediently. Faithfulness leads to spiritual growth, greater responsibility, Kingdom impact, and eternal rewards. Above all, faithful stewards live for the day when they will hear Christ say, “Well done, good and faithful servant.” Their greatest desire is not earthly success but God's approval and the privilege of bringing glory to Him.

Key Lesson

God rewards faithfulness. Those who faithfully manage what He entrusts to them will experience spiritual growth, Kingdom impact, greater responsibility, God's approval, and eternal rewards.

Final Course Summary

Introduction

Stewardship is one of the most important principles in the Christian life. It is the recognition that God is the Owner of all things and that believers are entrusted as managers of His resources. Everything we possess—our time, talents, finances, opportunities, relationships, influence, and spiritual gifts—has been entrusted to us by God for His purposes and glory.

Throughout this course, we have learned that stewardship is not limited to money. It encompasses every area of life. God calls His people to faithfully manage what He has given them and to use those resources in ways that honour Him, bless others, and advance His Kingdom.

A faithful steward understands that life is not about ownership but responsibility. The question is not, "What do I own?" but rather, "How am I managing what God has entrusted to me?"

The Foundation of Stewardship

The foundation of biblical stewardship is God's ownership.

Psalm 24:1

"The earth is the Lord's, and everything in it."

Everything belongs to God:

- Our lives
- Our families
- Our abilities
- Our possessions
- Our finances
- Our opportunities

Since God owns everything, believers are called to manage His resources according to His will.

Stewardship begins when we surrender ownership and acknowledge God's authority over every area of our lives.

Course Theme

Faithful Stewardship Honours God

Faithful stewardship honors God through wise management of time, talents, finances, resources, and opportunities entrusted to His people.

When believers faithfully manage what God has entrusted to them, they become instruments of His blessing, advance His Kingdom, impact future generations, and prepare themselves for the day they will stand before Christ.

COURSE SUMMARY

Throughout this course we have discovered that stewardship affects every area of life.

We learned that:

God owns everything.

Believers are managers, not owners.

Time must be used wisely because it cannot be recovered.

Talents and gifts should be developed and used for service.

Financial resources should be managed responsibly and generously.

Opportunities should be recognized and seized before they pass.

Faithfulness brings both present blessings and eternal rewards.

Stewardship is ultimately about representing God well with everything He places in our hands.

The faithful steward understands that every resource carries a responsibility and every blessing carries accountability.

Key Lesson

God owns everything, and believers are accountable stewards entrusted with managing His resources faithfully for His glory and Kingdom purposes.

STEWARDSHIP COURSE EXAMINATION

30 Questions

Instructions

Answer all questions. Select the best answer for multiple-choice questions.

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions

1. What is biblical stewardship?

- A. Owning everything you have
- B. Managing God's resources faithfully
- C. Giving money to the church
- D. Working hard

2. According to Psalm 24:1, who owns everything?

- A. Governments
- B. Individuals
- C. God
- D. Churches

3. What is the primary requirement of a steward?

- A. Wealth
- B. Education
- C. Faithfulness
- D. Popularity

4. Which scripture states that stewards must be found faithful?

- A. Matthew 6:33
- B. Romans 12:1
- C. 1 Corinthians 4:2
- D. John 3:16

5. Which of the following is NOT an area of stewardship?

- A. Time
- B. Talents
- C. Weather
- D. Finances

6. What does Ephesians 5:15–16 teach about time?

- A. Time should be ignored
- B. Time should be redeemed
- C. Time should be wasted
- D. Time should be controlled by others

7. According to Psalm 90:12, numbering our days gives us:

- A. Riches
- B. Fame
- C. Wisdom
- D. Authority

8. Who gives spiritual gifts?

- A. Parents
- B. Church leaders
- C. God
- D. Society

9. According to 1 Peter 4:10, gifts should be used to:

- A. Gain popularity
- B. Serve others
- C. Gain wealth
- D. Impress people

10. Which chapter teaches stewardship of financial resources?

- A. Chapter 2
- B. Chapter 3
- C. Chapter 4
- D. Chapter 5

11. According to Malachi 3:10, believers should:

- A. Ignore giving
- B. Bring the whole tithe
- C. Borrow money
- D. Save everything

12. What does Proverbs 3:9 teach?

- A. Honour the Lord with your wealth
- B. Avoid working
- C. Save all money
- D. Seek wealth only

13. According to 2 Corinthians 9:7, God loves a:

- A. Wealthy giver
- B. Reluctant giver
- C. Cheerful giver
- D. Famous giver

14. Opportunities should be:

- A. Ignored
- B. Delayed
- C. Maximized
- D. Avoided

15. According to Galatians 6:10, we should:

- A. Do good to all people
- B. Serve only ourselves
- C. Ignore others
- D. Compete with others

16. What did Jesus say about working while it is day?

- A. Rest completely
- B. Work only when convenient
- C. Do the works of God
- D. Wait for tomorrow

17. Faithfulness in little things leads to:

- A. Greater responsibility
- B. Laziness
- C. Failure
- D. Pride

18. What reward did the faithful servant receive in Matthew 25:21?

- A. Wealth only
- B. A new house
- C. The master's approval
- D. Popularity

19. According to Revelation 22:12, Jesus will:

- A. Ignore stewardship
- B. Bring rewards
- C. Remove responsibilities
- D. End opportunities

20. What is the overall theme of this course?

- A. Wealth creation
- B. Church growth
- C. Faithful stewardship
- D. Leadership development

Section B: True or False (5 Marks)

- 21. Stewardship only involves money.**
 - 22. God owns everything.**
 - 23. Time can be recovered once lost.**
 - 24. Every believer has gifts from God.**
 - 25. Faithfulness is important in stewardship.**
-

Section C: Short Answer Questions

- 26. Define biblical stewardship.**
- 27. Name four areas of stewardship.**
- 28. Why should believers use their gifts?**
- 29. Why is accountability important in stewardship?**
- 30. What words does every faithful steward desire to hear from the Lord?**